

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Diversity versus disparity

DIVERSITY -> difference of character: language, ecology, culture, crops

DISPARITY -> ranked inequality: income, literacy, health, infrastructure

POLICY -> diversity is accommodated; disparity is reduced

TRAP -> treating inequality as harmless variety is a direct exam error

MUST REMEMBER: Regional development links spatial inequality, cumulative causation, growth poles, spread and backwash, core-periphery, agropolitan and balanced/unbalanced strategies to India's planning regions, river-valley projects, industrial location, infrastructure corridors and district-level intervention.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Uneven development drivers

RESOURCE ENDOWMENT -> minerals, fertile land, ports or irrigation cluster growth

TRANSPORT + MARKET -> corridors and urban nodes outpace interiors

HISTORICAL HEAD START -> earlier centres keep cumulative advantage

STATE CAPACITY -> policy and governance decide whether lagging regions catch up

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Growth pole mechanism

PROPULSIVE NODE -> dynamic industry or city becomes the growth pole

LINKAGES -> suppliers, labour and markets cluster around the pole

SPREAD EFFECT -> benefits diffuse outward if linkages deepen locally

LIMIT -> a pole may remain an enclave without regional diffusion

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Core-periphery and backwash

CORE -> capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate

PERIPHERY -> labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core

BACKWASH -> talent and capital drain outward toward the core

SPREAD -> technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Planning region criteria

FUNCTIONAL UNITY -> flows and linkages hold the region together

ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY -> policy must actually be implementable

ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY -> strategy and resource base must align

SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY -> regional identity and needs affect success

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Indian planning timeline

1938 -> National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination

1950-51 -> Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched

1966-69 -> Annual Plans after war, drought and macro stress

2012-17 / 2015 -> Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: First versus Second Plan

FIRST PLAN -> irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power

SECOND PLAN -> heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

SPATIAL LOGIC -> agrarian recovery first, industrial concentration next

TRAP -> do not swap the priorities of the two plans

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Why imbalance persisted

UNEVEN IRRIGATION -> Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective
INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION -> ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead
CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS -> interiors remained infrastructure-poor
OUTCOME -> balanced regional development stayed incomplete

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Planning Commission versus NITI

PLANNING COMMISSION -> centralised plan formulation and outlay logic

NITI AAYOG -> think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

PLAN DOCUMENTS -> long-horizon allocation framework

DASHBOARDS -> indicator monitoring and mission-mode comparison

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: District and block targeting ladder

STATE AVERAGE -> useful but hides internal inequality

DISTRICT TARGETING -> Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus

BLOCK TARGETING -> scale moves further downward where district averages still hide gaps

GEOGRAPHIC LESSON -> intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Five Year Plans ended after the Twelfth Plan period and the Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog in 2015; plan strategy, Finance Commission transfers, centrally sponsored schemes, NITI cooperative/competitive federalism and constitutional local planning are institutionally distinct.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: SDG-style benchmarking

SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 -> overall India score 71

TERRITORIAL INDICATORS -> development is ranked spatially, not only nationally

CURRENT STYLE -> dashboards complement missions and programme convergence

SAFE USE -> planning changed form, but not the geography of disparity

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Damodar Valley, NCR, Dandakaranya, command areas, hill/tribal regions, Aspirational Districts and freight/industrial corridors show that growth-node benefits depend on linkages, displacement, skills, ecology and state capacity; convergence is an empirical result, not an automatic consequence of investment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Regional development answer spine

DEFINE -> disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planning

EXPLAIN -> growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash

TRACE -> 1938 committee, First Plan, Second Plan, NITI transition

QUALIFY -> district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity